

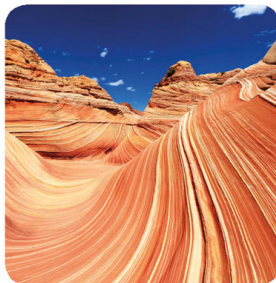
Types of rocks

There are three different groups of rock: igneous, sedimentary, and metamorphic. Rocks are classified into these three different groups, depending on how they were formed.



Igneous rock

Types of igneous rock include basalt (shown here) and granite. These are formed by volcanic eruptions.



Sedimentary rock

Types of sedimentary rock include sandstone (shown here), chalk, and limestone. These form in layers of tiny rock pieces.



Metamorphic rock

Types of metamorphic rock include marble (shown here), slate, and shale. These are formed by heat and pressure.

Rocks on the move

Movements in the Earth's crust are causing rocks to slowly change. Volcanoes erupt and mountains are pushed upwards, and the rocks that come to the surface are broken down by weathering. This rock is moved and dragged down into the Earth's crust again.

Weathering and erosion

Rocks on the surface are broken down into smaller pieces by weathering. Erosion breaks down the rocks further.

Transportation and deposition

Pieces of broken rock, called sediment, are moved along by wind or water, and eventually end up in lakes and oceans.

Sedimentation and cementation

In lakes and oceans, layers of broken rock, dead plants, and animal remains build up and stick together. This makes sedimentary rock.

**Sedimentary
rock**